



Air Quality Situation Report

Edmonton Folk Music Festival ·
Gallagher Park

Sun, Aug 9, 2026 · 5:12 AM MDT
For more information, contact Gary Redmond, ACA Executive Director at 780.935.4279

Air Quality Health Index (AQHI) — Edmonton

2.0

Current AQHI at Edmonton McCauley (1.66 km from venue)
Forecast Sun 7:00 AM: 2.3

Health Risk	AQHI	At-Risk Population	General Population
Low Risk	2.3	Enjoy your usual outdoor activities.	Ideal air quality for outdoor activities.

No active Environment Canada weather alerts for the venue.

Environmental Intelligence Summary

- At Edmonton Folk Music Festival, temperature is 13.5°C and feels near 13.3°C. Winds are 7 km/h from E, gusting near 13 km/h.
- The nearest current AQHI is 2 at Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km from the venue.
- The official Government of Alberta AQHI for Edmonton is 3 (forecast tonight: 4, tomorrow: 4).
- A gridded AQHI estimate blending official and community sensors (confidence: High) puts the area near 2.
- The nearest air monitoring station (Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km) reports fine particulate matter (PM2.5) at 22.3 µg/m³.
- An on-site community sensor ('ACA_EFMF-Office', 0.3 km) reads 26.1 µg/m³ PM2.5.
- Back-trajectory modeling (HRDPS wind fields, 6 h lookback) indicates the air currently at the venue traveled from the vicinity of a point 76.6 km to the SE, i.e. arriving from the SE.
- The nearest active fire detection (NASA FIRMS – VIIRS, last 2026-08-09) is 136.8 km S of the venue. The modeled back-trajectory does not pass near this fire (nearest approach 118.2 km), so this specific fire is unlikely to be the source of any smoke reaching the venue right now.
- The AQHI forecast for Sun 7:00 AM is 2.
- Thunderstorm conditions appear in the hourly forecast beginning around Sun 9:00 AM.
- Overall operational environmental risk is HIGH. Primary concerns are thunderstorm.

Recommendations

- Confirm lightning monitoring, shelter, pause and evacuation procedures.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — general population: Ideal air quality for outdoor activities.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — at-risk populations: Enjoy your usual outdoor activities.

Hazard Snapshot — Overall Risk: High Risk

AIR QUALITY Low Risk 2.3 AQHI	HEAT Low Risk 21.5 °C apparent/humidex	WIND Low Risk 19.8 km/h peak gust	PRECIPITATION Moderate Risk 3.8 mm/h maximum	THUNDERSTORM High Risk Sun 9:00 AM first forecast signal
AQHI RATE OF CHANGE Low Risk -1.0 AQHI change/hour			WIND SHEAR Low Risk 13.7 ° direction diff (10m vs 120m)	

Local Monitoring

Nearest station 2.0 Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km	Blended estimate 2.0 confidence High	PM2.5 (station) 22.3 µg/m³ Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km	PM2.5 (community) 26.1 µg/m³ ACA_EFMF-Office · 0.31 km
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